

Internship Performance Report

Retail Market Research / Competitive Benchmarking / Business Analysis

STUDENT:	Lê Phương Anh
SCHOOL:	Nguyen Tat Thanh Lower Secondary & High School | Grade 12
INTERNSHIP PERIOD:	April–June 2026 | Three months
WORKING ARRANGEMENT:	Remote / online | Workload equivalent to a standard internship
FUNCTIONAL ASSIGNMENT:	Retail business research and strategy-support analysis

01 Internship Scope Recap

The three-month internship focused on introductory business research relevant to retail investment and consulting. Working online, Phương Anh supported the review of publicly available retail information, structured comparisons of selected retail business models and the preparation of clear, management-oriented research summaries. The remote arrangement required regular ownership of assigned research tasks, careful file management and timely written communication. The scope was confined to supervised analysis and did not involve access to confidential investment material or authority over commercial decisions.

02 Work Performed and Responsibilities

2.1 Retail market research.

Phương Anh examined publicly available industry reports, company disclosures, retailer websites and market commentary to build an overview of Vietnam's retail landscape. Her work emphasised the differences between retail formats, customer segments, sales channels and value propositions. She organised the information by subject and source so that individual observations could be revisited and checked during subsequent analysis.

2.2 Competitive benchmarking.

She developed structured comparisons of retail businesses using consistent categories, including merchandise assortment, pricing and promotional propositions, store and online channels, customer-service approaches and signs of expansion. This approach provided a more useful basis for analysis than separate company descriptions and helped identify the commercial trade-offs behind different retail models.

2.3 Business insight and synthesis.

She consolidated the research into concise written findings, distinguishing evidence from interpretation and identifying where public sources were insufficient for a firm conclusion. Her summaries addressed practical questions of customer proposition, operating model and competitive differentiation rather than treating market size or store count as stand-alone measures of commercial quality.

2.4 Remote coordination and reporting.

Throughout the placement, the work depended on asynchronous communication, clear documentation and the ability to incorporate comments into subsequent versions. Phương Anh was expected to maintain the same standards of responsibility and task completion as an on-site intern, with research outputs serving as the principal basis for reviewing her contribution.



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03 Work Progression

APRIL | Orientation to the retail research question; initial market mapping; source review and information organisation.

MAY | Business-model comparison; competitor benchmarking and identification of customer and operating differences.

JUNE | Synthesis of commercial implications; refinement of findings and preparation of written research summaries.

04 Detailed Performance Evaluation

4.1 Research discipline and accuracy.

Phương Anh approached the research assignment methodically, with attention to the relevance and reliability of public sources. Her work showed an understanding that company-reported figures, independent commentary and analytical assumptions should not be treated as interchangeable. She was most effective when organising material around a defined research question and explaining why each source was useful to the comparison.

4.2 Commercial understanding and judgement.

She demonstrated developing business judgement by moving from collecting information about retailers to identifying meaningful differences in how they serve customers and operate. Her comparisons considered not only product offerings but also sales channels, positioning and service. Importantly, she treated conclusions based on limited public information as preliminary and avoided portraying descriptive comparisons as investment recommendations.

4.3 Quality and clarity of written work.

The principal value of her contribution lay in the organisation and communication of research. Her summaries brought related findings together under clear themes, allowing a reviewer to understand the evidence and the reasoning behind the stated implications. Her work also showed the importance of selecting only the information relevant to a business question rather than overwhelming the reader with background material.



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04 Detailed Performance Evaluation

4.4 Communication, teamwork and remote reliability.

The online arrangement required a level of personal organisation comparable to that expected of an in-person internship. Phương Anh worked within a format that placed emphasis on written updates, traceable work products and responsiveness to guidance. She gained practical experience in making her work understandable to others without relying on constant face-to-face explanation, an important skill in business research and collaborative working environments.

4.5 Learning attitude and development.

Over the course of the internship, Phương Anh strengthened her understanding of what distinguishes business analysis from a general market overview. She became more attentive to comparability, the limits of available evidence and the connection between observations and practical commercial questions. At her current educational stage, this willingness to improve the structure and usefulness of research is more meaningful than claims of advanced professional expertise.

05 Overall Evaluation

Phương Anh's internship provided relevant exposure to the disciplined research and communication required in a business-focused working environment. Her principal strengths were an organised approach to information, an emerging ability to compare retail business models and a clear interest in understanding how commercial decisions are informed by evidence. The three-month remote format also reinforced the importance of accountability, written coordination and independent task management.

The next stage of her development should involve deeper study of financial statements, unit economics and the relationship between customer proposition, operating costs and profitability. These are appropriate areas for further education rather than limitations in a Grade 12 internship. Overall, the placement served as a constructive introduction to retail business analysis and offers a sound foundation for further study in business, management or related fields.

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